RABBIT

Oryctolagus cuniculus

1. What can it see, hear, or feel?
Long ears swivel toward sounds, wide-set eyes watch all around, and a sniffing nose checks for danger.

2. Where does it live — and why?
It lives in meadows and woodland edges, with soft soil to dig a tunnel system called a warren.

3. How does it send messages?
It thumps its back feet hard to warn others, and a flash of white tail tells rabbits to run.

4. What does it do when something changes?
When something changes, it freezes, then bolts in a zigzag toward the nearest cover.

5. How does it learn?
Young rabbits watch their mother and older rabbits to learn safe feeding spots and alarm signals.

6. How does it have babies?
A mother has five or six blind, hairless babies in a hidden nest, and visits them at night.

7. What are its limits?
Open ground with no cover forces it to stay near its burrow, ready to sprint for safety.

8. What does this teach us?
A calm rabbit is still watching and smelling everything — sensing trouble before it arrives.

WHY IS THIS ANIMAL HERE?

Domestic rabbits come from the European rabbit, still wild in parts of Europe.

Wild European rabbits are now endangered across much of their range.

Disease, habitat loss, and hunting have reduced their numbers sharply.

When its habitat shrinks:

- fewer wild rabbits means less food for lynx, eagles, and foxes
- whole ecosystems depend on this one small animal
- domestic rabbits need careful care — they are not disposable pets

This place is not their natural home, but it can help keep the species alive.

THINK ABOUT THIS

If small sounds could warn you of danger, how quiet would you have to be yourself?

What a living thing can sense becomes its reality.
Environment shapes design.

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